

CarShake Time-Stamp Defense Checklist

Field guide | 30 August 2026 | carshake.online

CarShake Time-Stamp Defense Checklist

A practical field guide for documenting a vehicle before and after a valet or rental handover

This guide helps you create a clear, organized record. It is not legal advice and does not guarantee the outcome of a dispute.

The 8-Angle Photo Protocol

Take these eight wide photos before you hand over the keys, then repeat the same sequence immediately after pickup:

1. Front bumper and grille
2. Front-left corner, including the wheel
3. Driver side from front to rear
4. Rear-left corner and rear bumper
5. Rear-right corner and rear bumper
6. Passenger side from rear to front
7. Front-right corner, including the wheel
8. Hood, windshield, roofline, and visible cabin

For every existing mark, add two images:

- A wide photo showing where it is on the vehicle
- A close photo showing its shape and detail

Clear still images are usually easier to compare and reference than one continuous video. You may record video for context, but keep the still photos too.

Before Handover

- ☐ Start the record while the vehicle is still under your control.
- ☐ Confirm the vehicle and handover details are correct.
- ☐ Use the 8-angle sequence in one direction around the car.
- ☐ Include the handover location in at least one wide image.
- ☐ Photograph all four wheel faces and tire sidewalls.
- ☐ Record the dashboard, warning lights, odometer, and fuel or charge level.
- ☐ Photograph existing chips, scratches, dents, curb rash, glass damage, stains, or tears.

- ❑ Retake any photo blurred by motion, glare, darkness, or traffic.
- ❑ Generate and review the CarShake handover receipt.
- ❑ Share the same receipt or record with the other party when practical.
- ❑ Save the original photos, receipt, booking details, and messages.

Immediately After Pickup

- ❑ Do not leave the pickup area before inspecting the vehicle.
- ❑ Repeat the same 8-angle sequence in the same order.
- ❑ Compare the before and after views side by side.
- ❑ Photograph any new mark both wide and close.
- ❑ Record the odometer and fuel or charge level again.
- ❑ Keep the valet ticket, rental agreement, invoice, and payment receipt.
- ❑ Report suspected damage promptly through the business's stated process.
- ❑ Ask for the incident or claim reference in writing.

If You Find New Damage

1. Stay factual. Describe what you can see without guessing who caused it.
2. Preserve the original files. Do not crop, filter, or overwrite them.
3. Write down when and where you noticed the damage.
4. Ask the valet, hotel, or rental company to create an incident report.
5. Save names, roles, reference numbers, emails, and timestamps for every contact.
6. Request the relevant escalation or insurance process in writing.
7. Keep repair estimates and invoices separate from the original evidence.
8. Follow the deadlines in your agreement, insurance policy, and local process.

Evidence Folder Structure

Use one folder and keep filenames simple:

- 01-before-wide/
- 02-before-close/
- 03-handover-receipt/
- 04-after-wide/
- 05-after-close/
- 06-incident-report/
- 07-emails-and-messages/
- 08-estimates-and-invoices/

Final Quality Check

Your record is ready when another person can answer four questions without your help:

1. Which vehicle and handover does this concern?
 2. What was visible before the handover?
 3. What was visible immediately after pickup?
 4. Where are the original files and written communications?
-

CarShake | carshake.online

Educational information only. Rules and rights vary by agreement and location. For legal advice about a specific dispute, consult a qualified professional in the relevant jurisdiction.